

KAPSABET



SCHOOL

HIGH

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KAPSABET

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11th October 2022

Our Ref:.....

Date:.....

Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR OTIENO ROBERT, ADMISSION NUMBER 12458

Few students stand out on the horizon of my memory like Mars at perihelion. Robert, is one such student whose memories resurface. Robert was a Philomath when it came to essays, poetry and novels, and this never failed to show in our interactions. From his outspoken nature, meticulousness and passionate approach to learning, he was a beautiful mind to cultivate and interact with. I am more than privileged to be recommending him for admission to your institution.

Through his outspoken nature, Robert livened up our class discussions. He exemplifies charisma and unmatched prowess when it comes to debates and discussions. On one occasion during discussions with seniors on Chinua Achebe's *'Things Fall Apart'*, the seniors all argued that colonialism was the root cause of Africa's flotsam and jetsam. Robert, however, took a contrarian perspective that angered his colleagues but blessed them with the view of a different perspective. He cautioned the seniors against having a victim's mentality, reminding them that while the past is hard to bear it is the past. Before he could finish, a senior was affirming indeed that Africans were victims of injustices like slavery. Robert rebutted the senior reminding him how fellow African chiefs and kings aided in the process of slavery when they would raid rival villages and sell the males to their masters. The senior was left dumbfounded. I always looked forward to hearing what Robert's views were on thematic concerns addressed in our set texts. It is his mastery of content, calmness in the midst of rejoinders in debate and discussions that make me reminisce about Robert as one of the few students of English I have ever taught. I am sure Robert eagerly awaits to recover his lively class presence.

Robert was a meticulous student. His approach to finding answers and solutions was one which paid attention to every detail, every word and every illustration as evidenced in his essays. Most students simply went about essay writing in a bid to fill the pages, drawing unpointed illustrations and employing redundancy. His most famous essay- *'The African Argument'*- addressed the traditions versus modernity from the perspective of an African mind. In the introduction, Robert pictured how many Africans are caught in the bridge between modernity and African traditions, wanting to cross over to modernity but their limbs heavy with traditions. He then explored the pros and cons of African traditions, shedding focused light on specific cultures from which he then explores modernity as a package. Robert argued that while some traditions like communal togetherness were objective and meant well for Africans, some like FGM and wife inheritance were to be discarded.

He held the same argument with modernity, claiming it had brought magnificent fruits to Africans like industrialisation while cautioning the reader to avoid by all means the traps of modernity like excessive consumerism. He summarised the purpose of the essay through the Niger proverb: *'The same sun that melts the wax, hardens the clay'*, concluding that both modernity and traditions have their good and bad, and whichever the reader chooses is their own decision. This 12-page masterpiece, along with its diction and specificity earned him reviews from renowned Kenyan authors like Tony Muchama and Barak Muluka, who donated extra books to the school's English department due to the outstanding nature of *'The African Argument'*. Given the resources your institution will grant him, I am certain Robert will utilize them to continue drawing creative work while sticking to his meticulousness.

Robert was not originally a good student in poetry. He would come for consultations in my office no matter what he had scored to share what was the reasoning behind his answers whether wrong or correct. He would borrow anthologies from my office and go read them all. When he returned them after finishing, he had grasped the reasoning behind various poems by being in the shoes of the persona. Once when he borrowed Rudyard Kipling's *'Toomai of the Elephants'*, Robert envisioned himself as the persona, swallowing all of his myseries and facing the day head-on. I learnt that Robert eagerly wanted to excel in poetry and pushed himself to that effect by reading multiple poems from different authors in different eras. This saw him eventually become an excellent student in poetry and essay writing. I guessed by looking at the whole landscape of poetry, he had found means of navigation to excellence in the field. He inspired other members of the class to approach poetry by getting exposed to various poetic verses. On one occasion when we were motivating his class, I remember he was called to give a vote of thanks which he did very well. However, he iced the cake by presenting to us *'Invictus'* by William Ernest Henly off his head. All eyes were glued to him, ears listening as he presented line after line of the poem. The result was expected, as teachers and students stood up clapping for him as the poem had aligned with the agenda that had us gathered all there. I know Robert may face academic difficulties in your institution. However, I trust in his ability to approach the difficulties and solve them through his curious nature and willingness to get exposed to resources that may aid him.

From his way with words, Robert was a lover of light-hearted moments as well. From our conversations and class discussions, he knew when to stretch a good argument humorously while also holding tact. During a class debate on which account of creation was precise between the Big Bang version, Darwinian theory or the religious account, the team defending the Big Bang Theory constantly quoted Isaac Newton's words on gravitational pull granting the universe the ability to create itself from nothing. They forced their view on the audience, prompting opposing teams not to argue because Sir Isaac Newton was one of the greatest science minds that ever lived and well, who could argue with such a mind? However, when Robert stood to discuss the religious version, he decided to go on the offensive. He brought John Lennox's words, reminding the Big Bang team that nonsense remains nonsense even when spoken by famous scientists. Bursts of laughter filled the class, with the religious team stomping their feet in support of Robert as they struggled not to crack their ribs. He had beaten the Big Bang team at their own game. The students and judges couldn't contain their laughter at Robert's witty humorous remarks.

I am confident that Robert will look to bloom wherever he is planted and demonstrate the need to empower your community as well through his inclusive personality. You have my utmost assurance on that. He holds a lot of promise, which I know you will all collectively realize. I will miss him, though.

Yours sincerely,

Mr. Isaiah Yator.

